YOUSEF ABDELGHANI ▶
Ambassador of Jordan to India

WAR IS NOT AN ANSWER

Peace, neutrality and respect for territorial sovereignty—these were the main things Jordanian ambassador to India Yousef Abdelghani said were guiding his country's position amid conflict in West Asia. Speaking at the India Today conclave, he pointed out that despite being located in a volatile region, Jordan has always pursued peaceful conflict resolution.

In the backdrop of US president Trump saying the map of Iran might change after the war and chatter about 'Greater Israel', Abdelghani dismissed such talk as "nonsense", voting for cartographic stability. Addressing the criticism that Jordan's neutrality tantamounts to support for Israel, Abdelghani stressed that his country does not support any side and is committed to protecting its sovereignty—before the conflict Jordan had asked both Iran and Israel not to use its airspace to fire missiles. He also condemned attacks on civilian infrastructure in the Gulf as well as the US attack on an Iranian school, saying Jordan, too, had been hit.

Abdelghani highlighted the growing India-Jordan partnership, noting the friendship between PM Narendra Modi and King Abdullah II, cooperation in renewable energy, fertilisers, and the aim to expand bilateral trade from $3 billion (Rs 27,900 cr) to $5 billion (Rs 46,600 cr) in five years. Lasting peace in West Asia, he said, is essential for global stability, including India's strategic and economic interests. ■



ATUL KUMAR YADAV

War doesn't accomplish anything. It only brings agony and hardship for the people—not only energy crisis but in people-to-people connections too

Changing the map of a settled Middle East is nonsense—Jordan believes in the territorial sovereignty of all countries in the region and beyond

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Jordan advocates dialogue over conflict. Neutrality is central to its foreign policy
- It is not in the interests of any big country to destabilise West Asia
- Jordan asked both Iran and Israel not to use its airspace for missile strikes. Israel has complied
- Strong India-Jordan ties are expanding across trade, energy and strategic cooperation